

Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

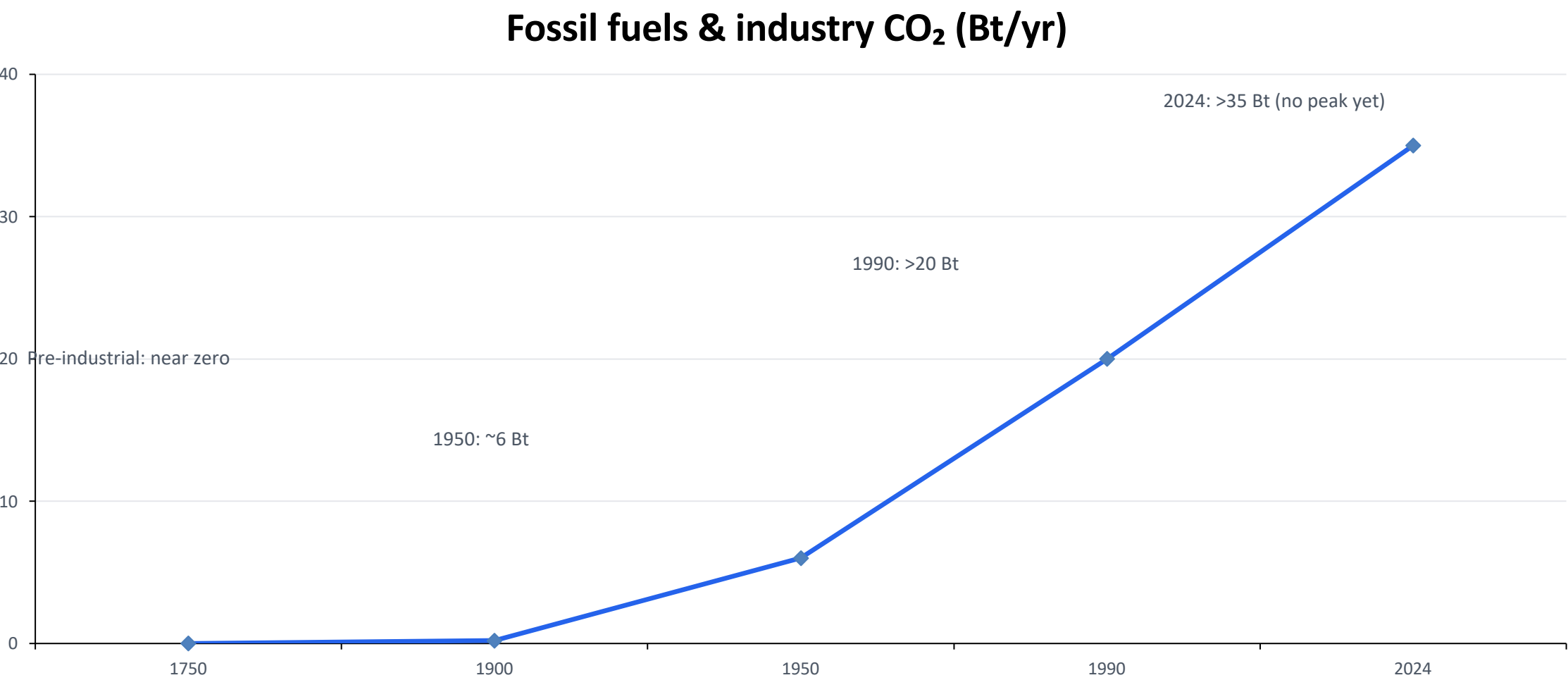
Fossil fuels & industry • 1750–2024

For policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

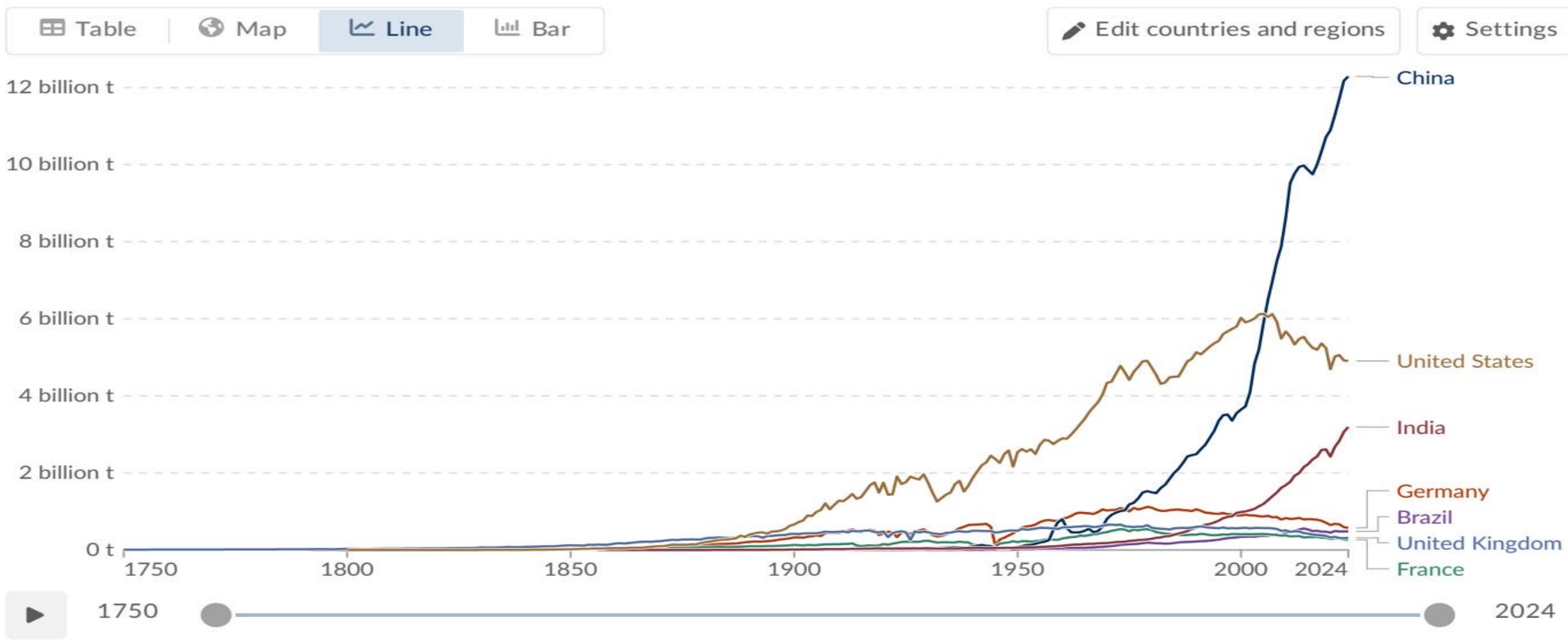
Scope: CO₂ from fossil fuels & industry (excludes land-use change)

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Milestones from source brief (Bt CO₂/yr, approx.).

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under 1/3

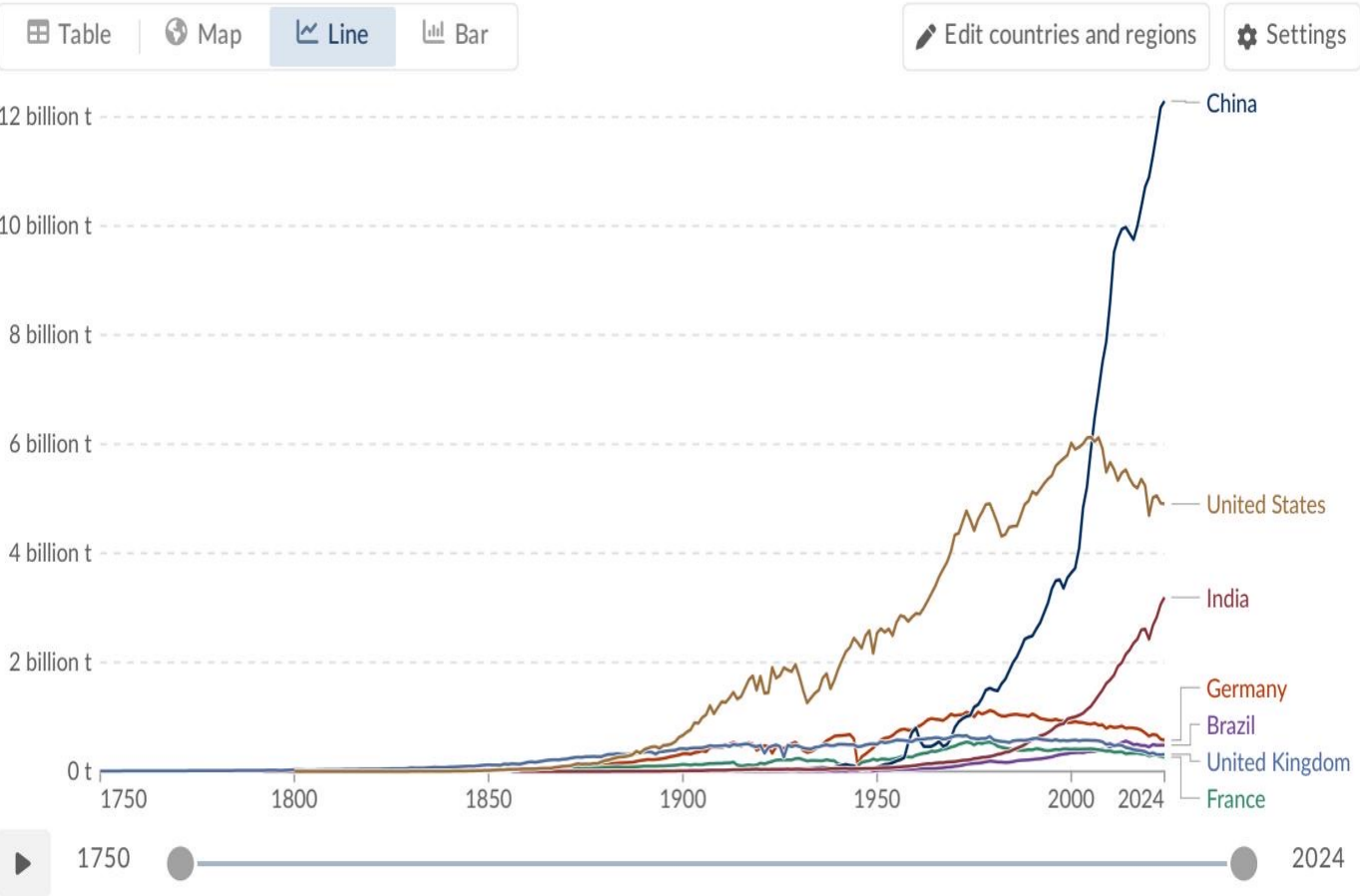


Data source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
OurWorldinData.org/co2-and-greenhouse-gas-emissions | CC BY

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Figure reference (OWID / Global Carbon Budget 2025): share of global CO₂ emissions by country over time.
Key context: 1900 Europe+US >90%; today <1/3 (source brief).

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



2024 shares (approx.)

- China: ~31% (rising, growth slowing)
- United States: ~13% (declining)
- India: ~8% (rising)
- EU-27: ~6% (declining)
- Russia: ~5% (roughly stable)

Data source: Global Carbon Budget (2025) - [Learn more about this data](#)
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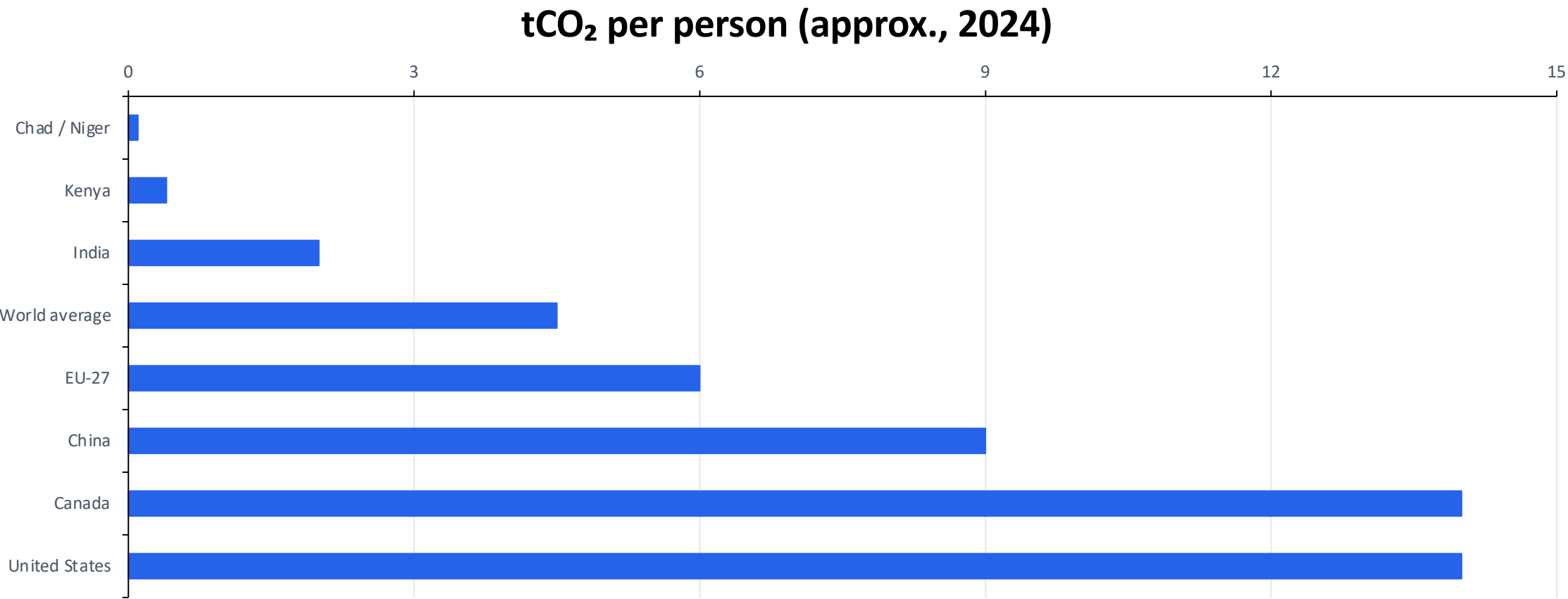
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Visual reference: country shares over time (OWID).
Shares from Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data (source brief).

Chart placeholder (treemap or bar)

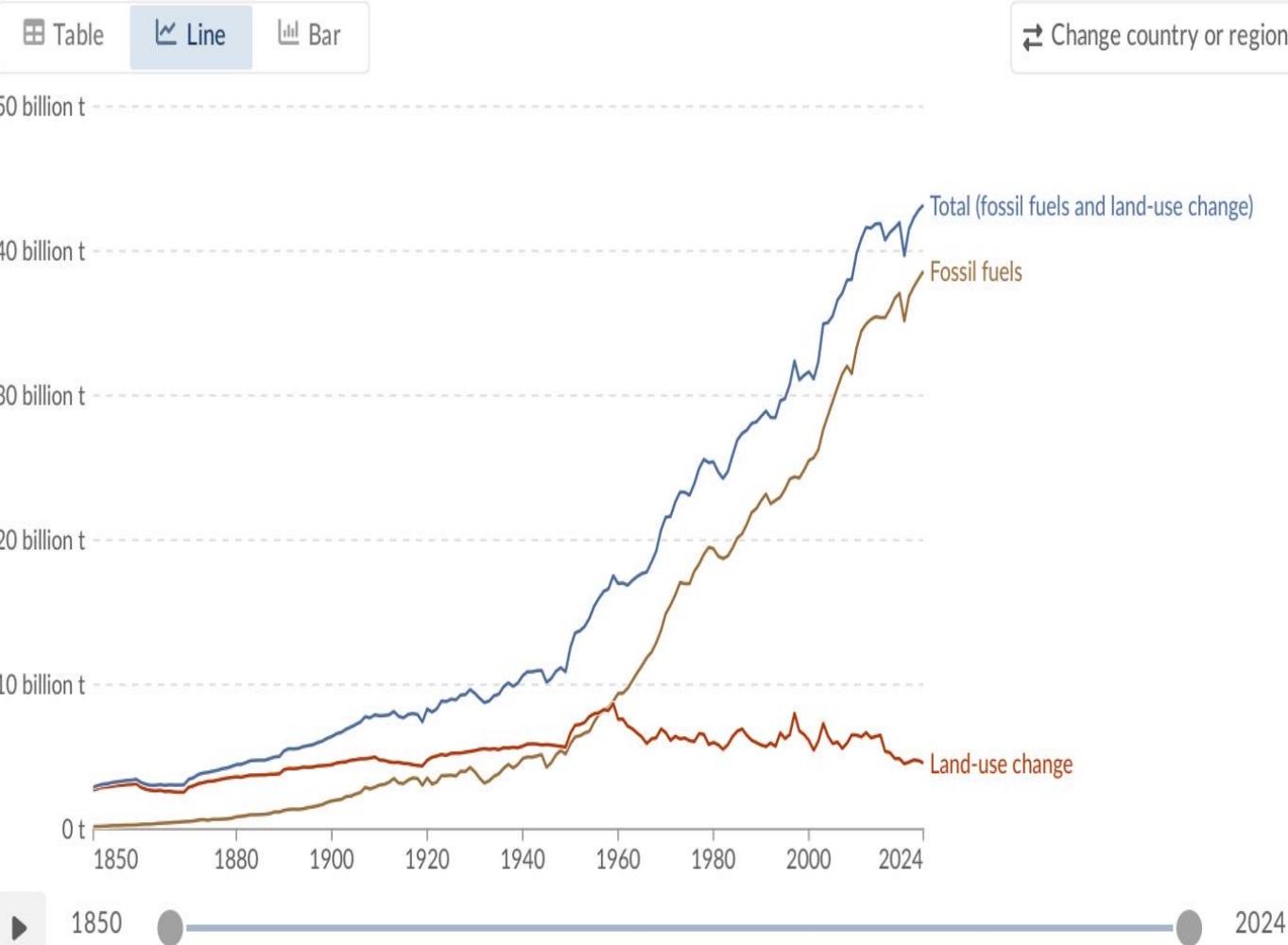
Show country shares of global CO₂ in 2024 using the listed values: China ~31%, US ~13%, India ~8%, EU-27 ~6%.

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US



Interpretation
Per capita view reframes responsibility beyond totals.
Even with similar living standards, per person emissions can differ substantially (energy mix).

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China



2024 per-capita snapshot (approx.)

US: ~14 t; Canada: ~14 t

China: ~9 t; South Africa: ~7 t

EU-27: ~6 t; World: ~4.5 t; UK: ~4 t

India: ~2 t; Kenya: ~0.4 t

Chart placeholder (multi-line)

Optional: multi-line per-capita trend lines for US, China, India, EU-27, World average (see figure reference).

Figure reference (OWID): per-capita CO₂ emissions over time.
Values from source brief table; trend context from figure reference.

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Part

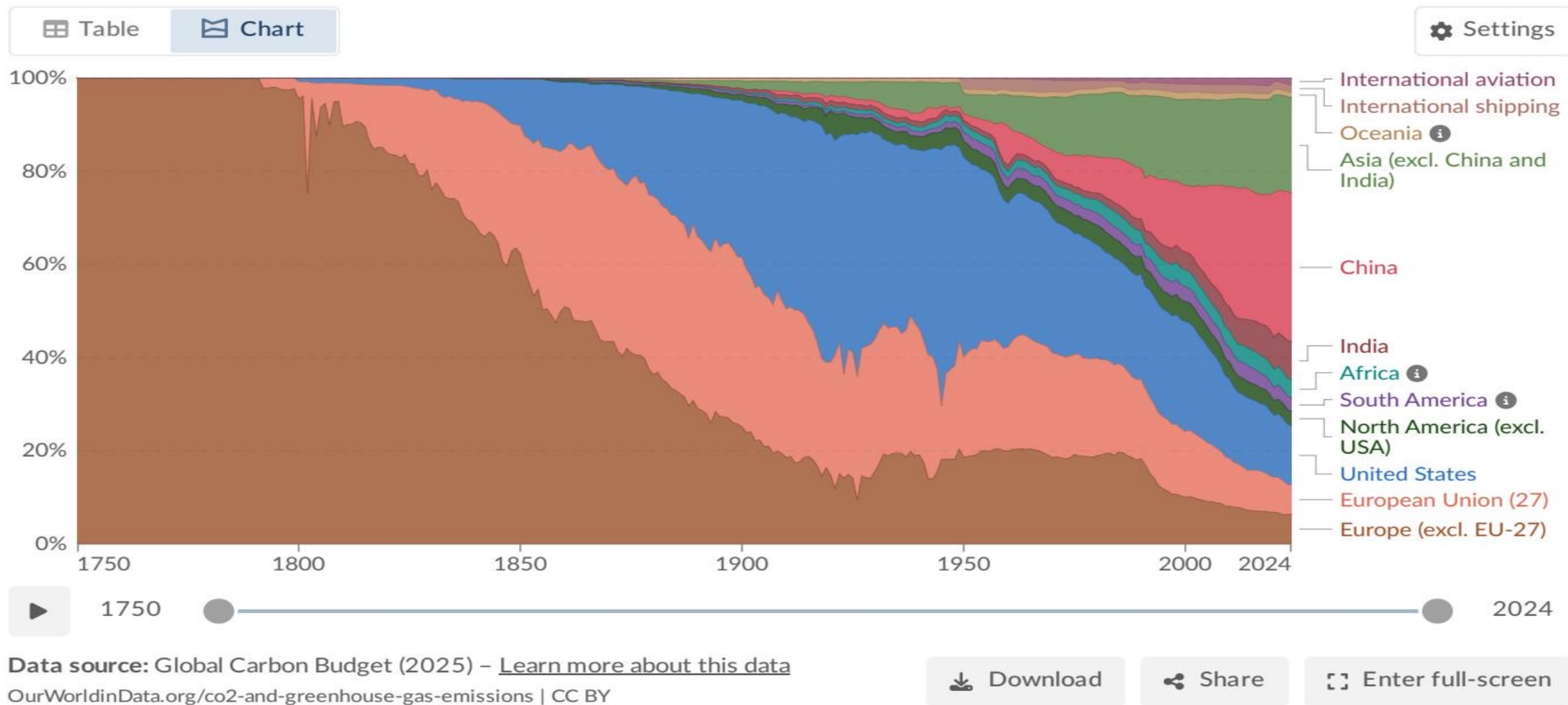


Figure reference (OWID): annual % change in CO₂ emissions in 2024.
Qualitative read from source brief: US/EU/UK down; Russia, parts of SE Asia & Africa up; some Central Asia >10%.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita

Chart placeholder (comparative bars)

Compare per-capita emissions: US ~14 t, EU-27 ~6 t, UK ~4 t (approx., 2024).

Mechanism (qualitative, from brief)

Among wealthy countries, per-capita emissions vary with electricity generation mix.

France/UK/Portugal: lower per capita due to higher nuclear & renewable energy.

Germany/Netherlands/US: higher per capita where fossil fuels play a large role.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

What to carry into policy discussions

Global CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked (fossil fuels & industry).

China is the largest annual emitter (~31%), but per-capita remains below the US (~9 t vs ~14 t).

Historical responsibility shifted: Europe+US >90% in 1900, now <1/3.

Per-capita inequality persists: ~0.1 t (Chad/Niger) to ~14 t (US/Canada) $\approx$ 150 $\times$.

Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.